

PrintDeck

USER MANUAL

Navigation, setup and everyday printer control



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A short visual guide to the screens, shortcuts and product variants.

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POCKET-SIZED PRINTER COMPANION

Your printers. One glance away.

PrintDeck brings live printer status and camera views into one lightweight device you can keep exactly where you need it. Move between multiple printers, follow long jobs and stay informed without opening another dashboard.

**01 POCKET-SIZED**

Light and compact enough to move from the desk to the workshop.

02 QI WIRELESS CHARGING

Recharge on a compatible Qi pad - no cable routine required.

03 MAGNETIC BY DESIGN

Strong mounting for steel surfaces such as a refrigerator or printer enclosure.

04 ADVANCED MONITORING

Live status, controls, cameras and saved printers in one touch-first interface.

05 CAMERA VIEWS

Check supported local printer cameras directly from PrintDeck.

06 LONG-RUN BATTERY

A large battery is designed to stay with even extended print sessions.

Three purpose-built forms for PrintDeck - designed to be printed, adapted and made your own.



01 THE RIVERSTONE

A pocket-sized round case with MagSafe-compatible Qi charging and integrated magnets for refrigerators, tool cabinets and other metal surfaces.



AUTHOR / CREDIT

Design: kitek



02 THE SCUTTLE

A low, sculpted round enclosure with a clean white shell and contrasting ring and button that can be printed in your own color.



AUTHOR / CREDIT

Design: Gulios



03 SNAPMAKER U1 MONITOR

A miniature companion to the tool-changing Snapmaker U1. Its square PrintDeck screen becomes the dedicated status console the printer was always meant to have.



AUTHOR / CREDIT

Design: kitek

Configuration, Updates and Factory Reset

A guided first start takes only a few minutes. Keep PrintDeck, your phone or computer and every printer on the same local Wi-Fi network.

PrintDeck Web Installer

<https://printdeck.xyz/firmware/>

01 OPEN INSTALLER

On a PC or Mac, open the installer in desktop Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge. Mobile browsers, Safari and Firefox cannot access the USB serial port.

02 CHOOSE & INSTALL

Select the latest release and the correct display. Connect a USB-C data cable, choose First installation / Factory reset, select the ESP32 serial device and wait for 100%.

03 JOIN PRINTDECK WI-FI

After restart, scan the QR code or join the unique open PrintDeck-XXXXXX network shown on the display. No password is required. A no-internet warning is normal during setup.

04 OPEN WI-FI SETUP

The Wi-Fi setup page should open after you connect. If it does not, stay connected and open <http://printdeck.local>. Use <http://192.168.4.1> only as the fallback address.

05 JOIN YOUR NETWORK

Choose Scan networks, select your usual Wi-Fi and enter its password. Choose Check & save Wi-Fi. PrintDeck keeps setup open and stores the details only after the network supplies an IP address.

06 ADD YOUR PRINTERS

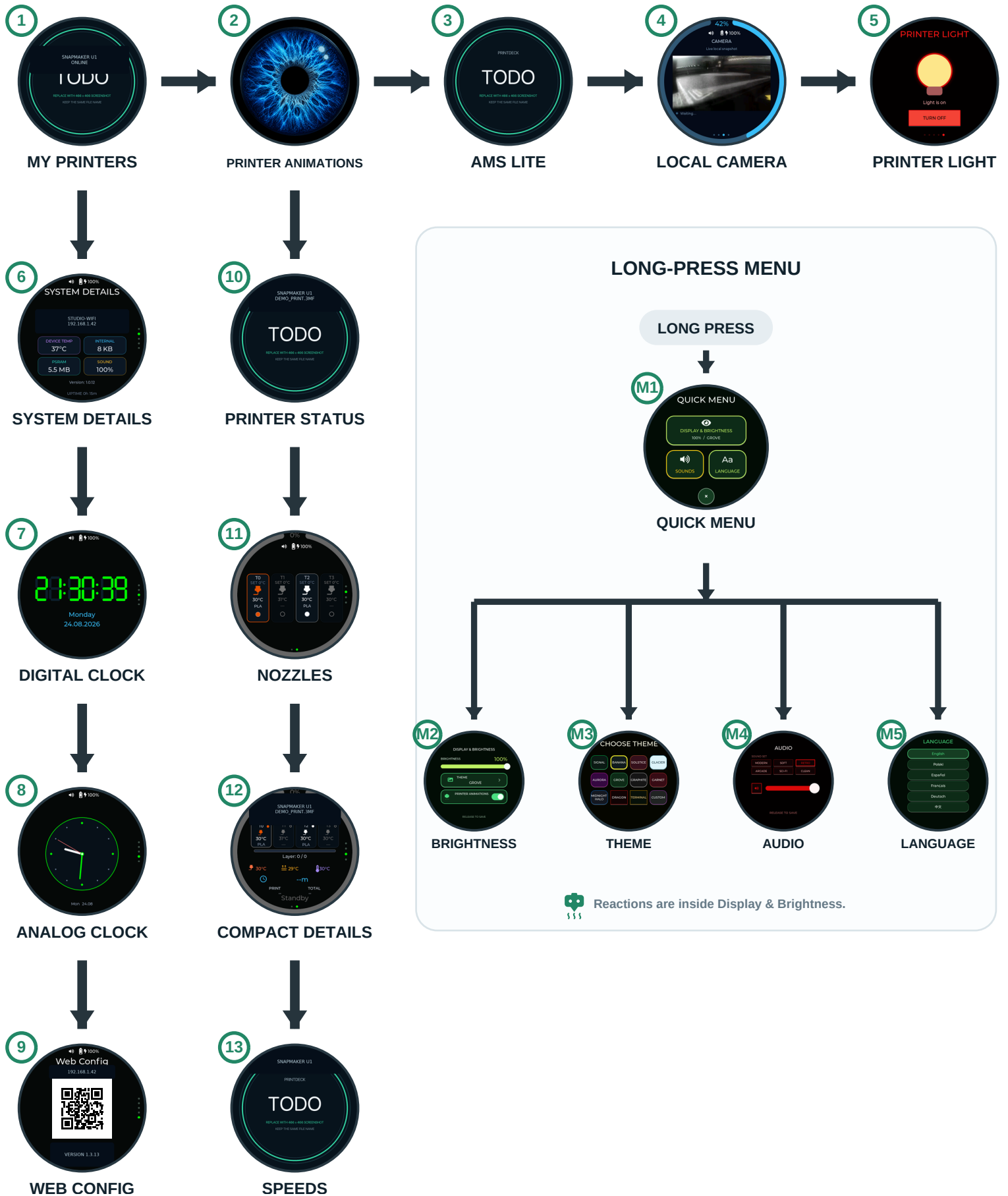
Reconnect to normal Wi-Fi. Open PrintDeck's Web Config address and add your printer. Choose Klipper / Moonraker, Bambu Lab, Prusa or a supported Elegoo family. Prusa and Elegoo are marked Experimental.

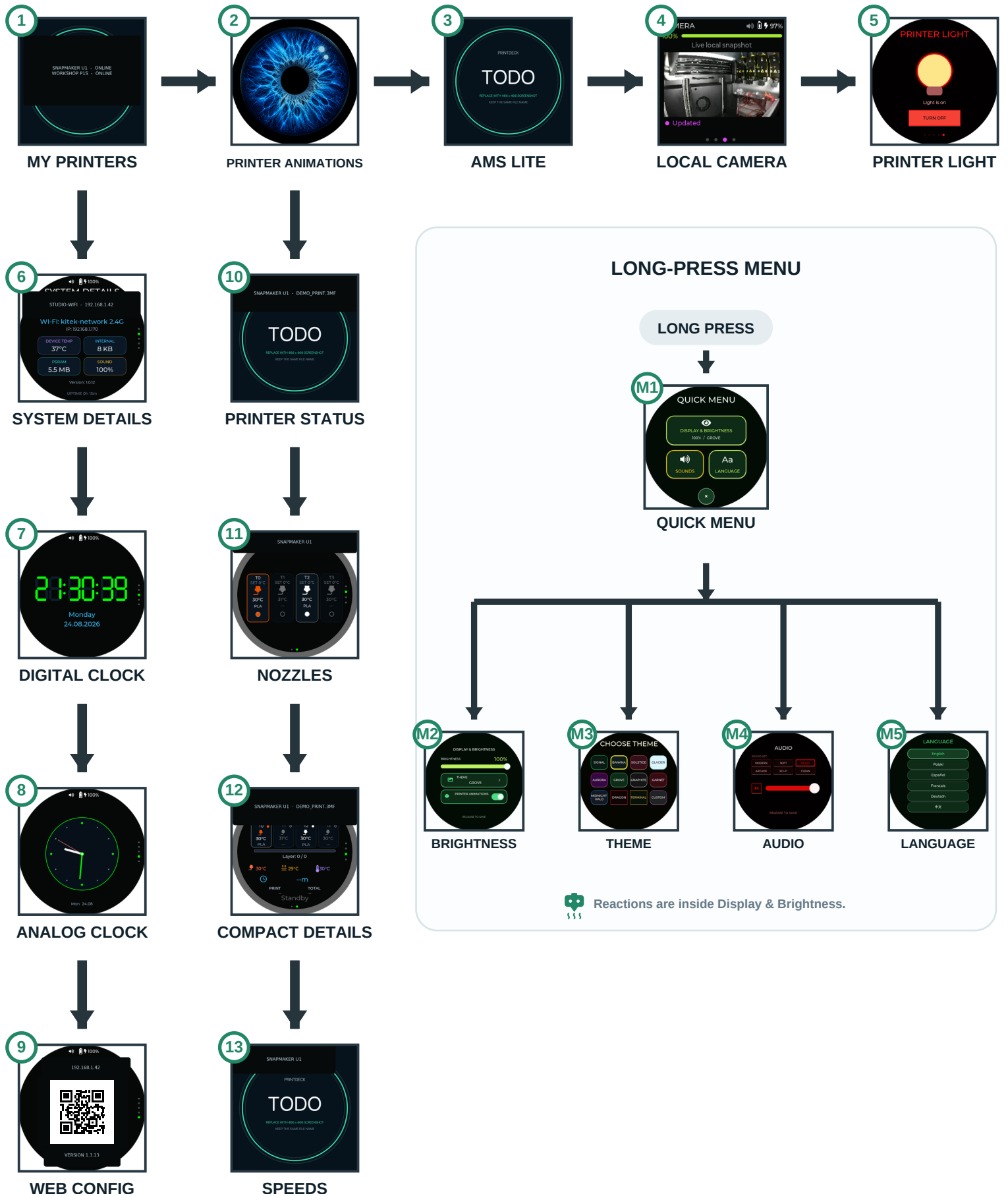
UPDATE WITHOUT LOSING SETTINGS

For the easiest update, open Web Config and choose Device > Firmware > Check for updates, then confirm Install update. Keep PrintDeck powered while it downloads, validates and restarts. You can also return to the Web Installer, choose Firmware update and update over USB. Both update paths preserve saved Wi-Fi, printers and display settings.

FACTORY RESET

Use the Web Installer and choose First installation / Factory reset only when setting up a new display or intentionally starting again. Confirm the full erase when prompted. This removes Wi-Fi, printers and preferences stored on PrintDeck, but it does not change anything on the printer or its controller. After restart, repeat the Wi-Fi setup shown above.





SCREEN REFERENCE

SCREEN NAVIGATION

- 1 MY PRINTERS**
Your starting point for saved printers. Check availability at a glance and open a ready printer with one tap.
- 2 PRINTER ANIMATIONS**
The first printer page when Reactions are enabled. Its animation follows heating, printing, pausing, completion and other live states.
- 3 AMS LITE**
A clear overview of loaded materials and feeder positions whenever a compatible Bambu system is available.
- 4 LOCAL CAMERA**
A local live view from the printer camera for a quick visual check without leaving PrintDeck.
- 5 PRINTER LIGHT**
See and change the printer's chamber or work light from a focused control screen.
- 6 SYSTEM DETAILS**
Review connectivity, power, memory, temperature and firmware information when checking device health.
- 7 DIGITAL CLOCK**
A clean full-screen clock for the desk, with the current day and date always visible.

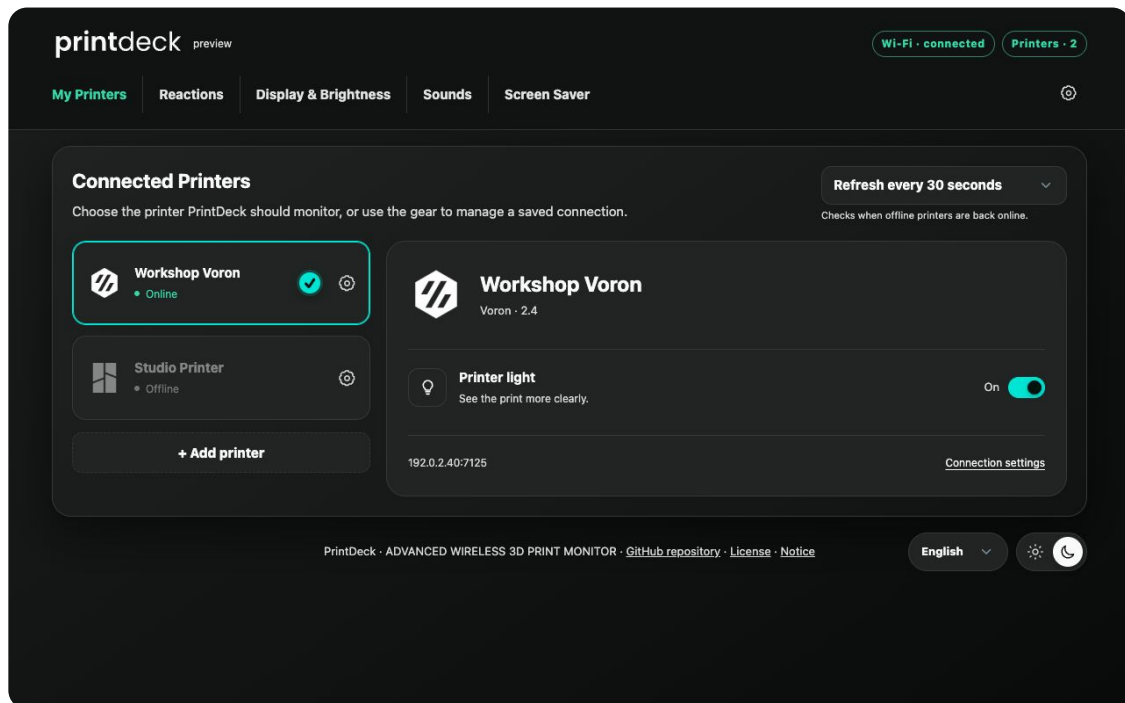
LONG-PRESS NAVIGATION

- M1 QUICK MENU**
Long-press any regular screen to open fast access to everyday display and sound settings.
- M3 THEME**
Choose the visual theme that best matches your setup.
- M5 LANGUAGE**
Choose the interface language used by the device.

- 8 ANALOG CLOCK**
A calm analog time view that turns PrintDeck into a useful ambient desktop display.
- 9 WEB CONFIG**
Open PrintDeck settings from a phone or computer using the shown local address or QR code.
- 10 PRINTER STATUS**
The main live dashboard. Follow print progress, temperatures, remaining time and the current printer state.
- 11 NOZZLES**
Monitor the active tool and available nozzles, including current and target temperatures.
- 12 COMPACT DETAILS**
A dense but readable print summary with key timing, layer and temperature information in one place.
- 13 SPEEDS**
Track speed, flow, fan, position and heater output while the printer is working.

Web Configuration Panel

Configure PrintDeck from a phone, tablet or computer on the same Wi-Fi network. The panel runs locally on the device and does not require a cloud account.



WEB CONFIG

OPEN THE PANEL

Use the address or QR code on screen (9)

Open WEB CONFIG on PrintDeck. Scan its QR code, or enter the displayed `printdeck.local` address in your browser. The IP address in System Details remains available as a fallback. Your browser device and PrintDeck must be connected to the same local Wi-Fi.

INSTANT FEEDBACK

Changes appear on PrintDeck

Open Settings > Live View to see and control the physical PrintDeck screen over local Wi-Fi. Tap, hold or swipe the image, use the four navigation arrows and choose a one-to-five-second refresh rate. USB is not required.

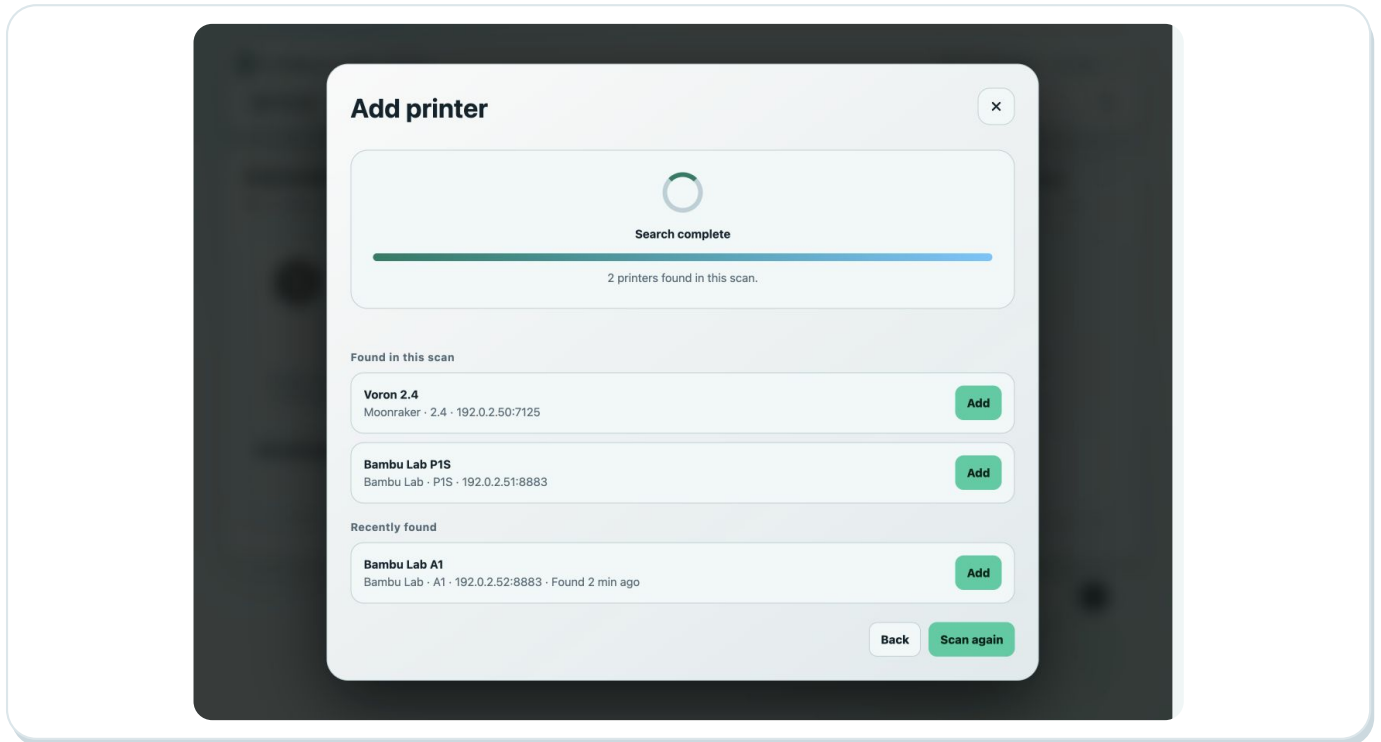
LOCAL BY DESIGN

Your network stays in control

The panel is served by PrintDeck on your LAN. Monitoring uses each supported printer family's local connection. No printer cloud account is required and printer telemetry is not uploaded. Elegoo Carbon families are experimental.

Web Config - My Printers: Scanner

The fastest way to add a printer is to let PrintDeck identify compatible devices on your current local network.



FIND MY PRINTER ON NETWORK

How the scanner works

Open My Printers, choose Add printer, then select Find my printer on network. PrintDeck immediately shows results found during the last five minutes while starting a fresh scan of the current local subnet. New matches appear under Found in this scan; cached matches remain under Recently found with their age. A scan never adds, edits or selects a printer by itself.

AFTER A MATCH

Verify and add several printers

Choose Add beside a result. Review its family and connection details. Moonraker, Bambu Lab, Prusa and supported Elegoo families use their own checks. Carbon 2 requires LAN Mode and its access code. Only a successful Check & add saves the profile. PrintDeck then marks the result Added. Manual entry remains available when discovery cannot find a service.

Web Config - Moonraker Printer

Connect Klipper-based printers directly through the Moonraker HTTP API available on your local network.

CONNECTION FIELDS

Address the Moonraker service

Printer name is the friendly label shown throughout PrintDeck. Enter the printer IP address or hostname and its Moonraker port; 7125 is the usual default. An API key is optional on a trusted LAN and is needed only when your Moonraker configuration requires one.

PRINTER IDENTITY

Detect, review and connect

Detect printer reads Moonraker information and printer.cfg without changing the printer. When recognized, it suggests the manufacturer and model; both fields remain editable. Check & add verifies the current address and API key before saving. When adding from a scan, PrintDeck returns to the result list so more printers can be added without losing the recent matches.

Web Config - Bambu Lab Printer

Bambu Lab printers connect directly over the local MQTT/TLS service. No Bambu cloud account is used.

The screenshot shows the first step of the 'Add Bambu Lab printer' form. It is titled 'Add Bambu Lab printer' with a close button (X). Below the title, it says 'Local-only MQTT connection; no cloud account is used.' The form has several input fields: 'Printer name' (pre-filled with 'Bambu Lab P1S'), 'Bambu Lab IP address or hostname' (pre-filled with '192.0.2.51'), 'Printer serial number' (pre-filled with 'PREVIEWSERIAL01'), and 'LAN access code' (with a 'Show' button). Below these fields, there is a note: 'To find this code, open the LAN Only Mode or Developer Mode screen on the printer and copy the code shown there. You do not need to enable either option.' At the bottom, there is a 'Generate report' button and a 'Check & add' button.

The screenshot shows the second step of the 'Add Bambu Lab printer' form. It is titled 'Add Bambu Lab printer' with a close button (X). Below the title, it says 'Local-only MQTT connection; no cloud account is used.' The form has an input field for 'LAN access code' (with a 'Show' button). Below this field, there is a note: 'To find this code, open the LAN Only Mode or Developer Mode screen on the printer and copy the code shown there. You do not need to enable either option.' At the bottom, there is a 'Generate report' button and a 'Save & connect' button.

LOCAL LAN CONNECTION

Collect three values from the printer

Enter the printer IP address or hostname and its serial number. To find the LAN access code, open the LAN Only Mode or Developer Mode screen on the printer and copy the code shown there; neither option needs to be enabled. Check & add requires one authenticated MQTT/TLS report before the profile is saved. The code remains on PrintDeck and is never sent to an external service.

OPTIONAL COMPATIBILITY REPORT

Help improve PrintDeck

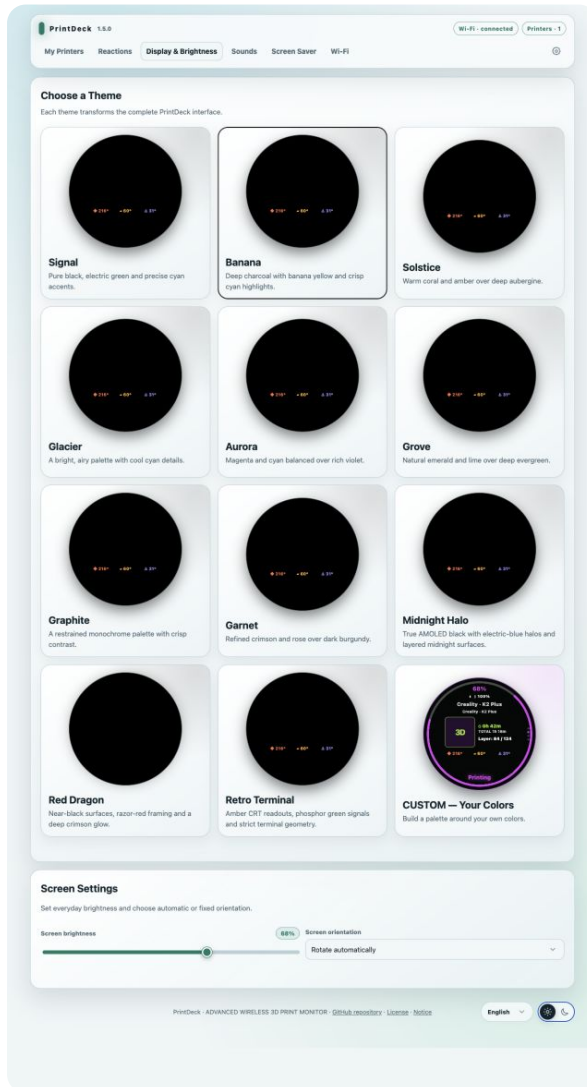
The report records the fields exposed by the printer and how their values are formatted. Model and firmware differences can introduce new fields or safe numeric ranges, so sharing it helps PrintDeck support more Bambu Lab printers. The report excludes connection details, access codes and print names. It stays on your device: nothing is uploaded or sent automatically. Download the report and email it to us only if you choose to share it.

Send the downloaded report to support@printdeck.xyz

Web Config - Display & Brightness

Shape the PrintDeck interface and see brightness, orientation and theme choices reflected on the device immediately.

THEMES - COMPLETE SECTION



THEMES

Choose a visual system

Theme cards preview printer data and status colours before you choose one. Custom lets you edit and save the complete palette.

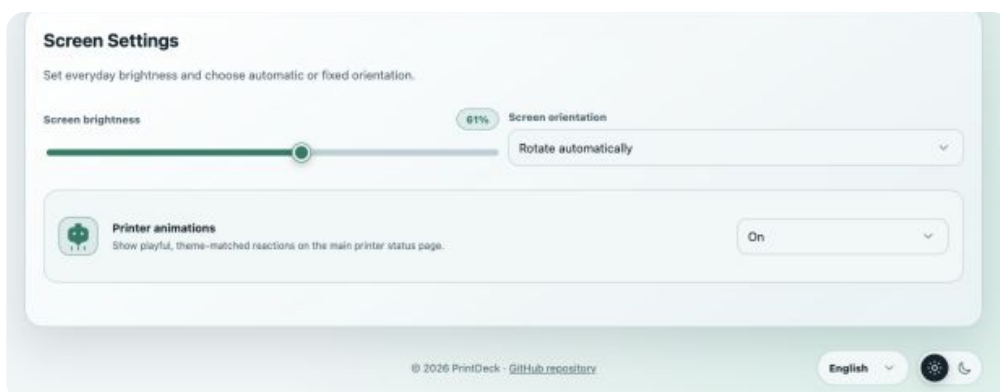
SCREEN SETTINGS

Brightness & orientation

Set everyday brightness and choose automatic orientation or lock the screen to a fixed rotation.



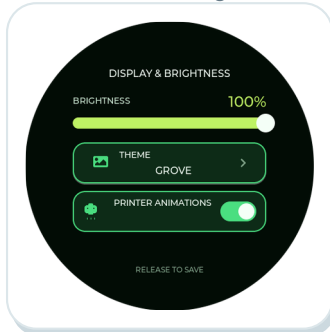
SCREEN SETTINGS - BRIGHTNESS & ORIENTATION



Reactions

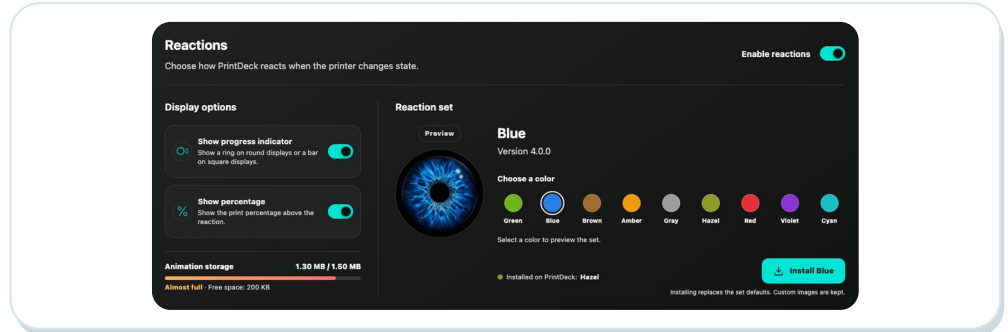


Reactions add a first printer page whose animation follows the current activity. Web Config has three independent visibility switches: Reactions, progress ring or bar, and percentage. The ring or bar and percentage are on by default. Round displays use a ring; square displays use a bar. Printer Status stays unchanged.



ON PRINTDECK

Long-press a regular screen, open Display & Brightness and use the Reactions switch.



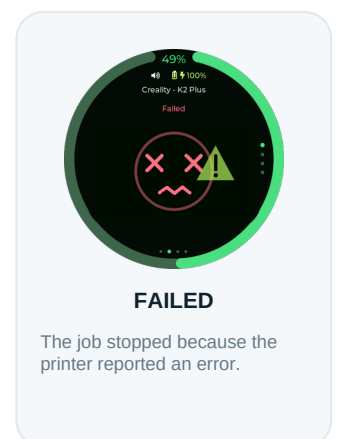
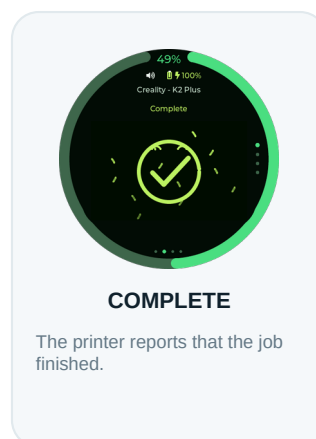
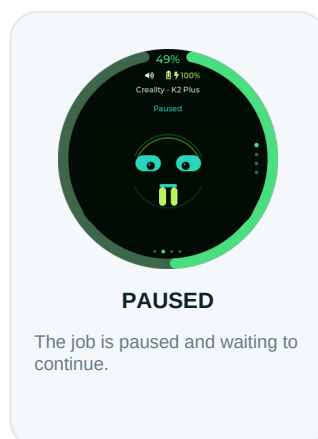
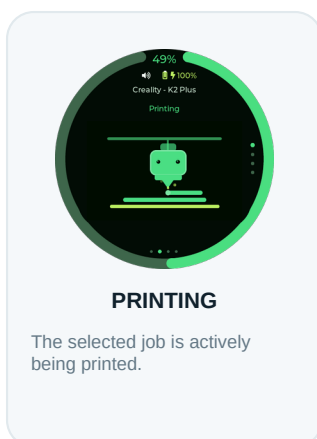
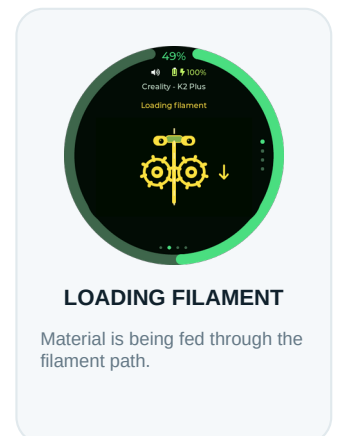
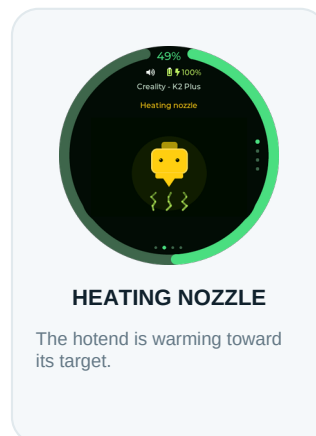
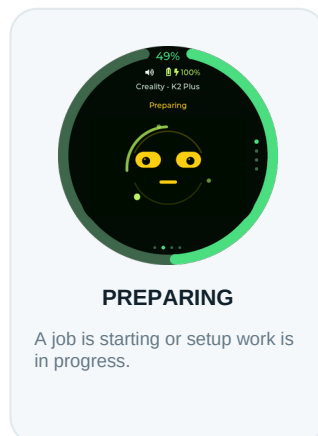
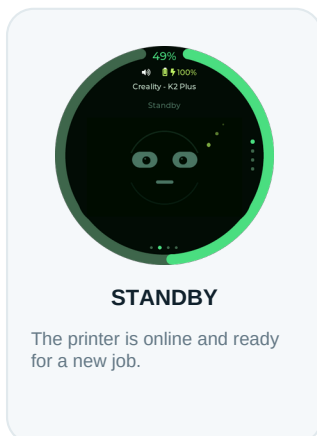
IN WEB CONFIG

Enable reactions at the top. Display options and animation storage are on the left. Select a color beside the eye to preview a set, then choose Install and confirm. Previewing keeps the installed set and event images unchanged. With reactions off, installation and event editing are disabled. Below, customize individual events by uploading an image, switching an event off or resetting it to the installed set default. Custom images stay active when you install another set.



WHAT EACH REACTION MEANS

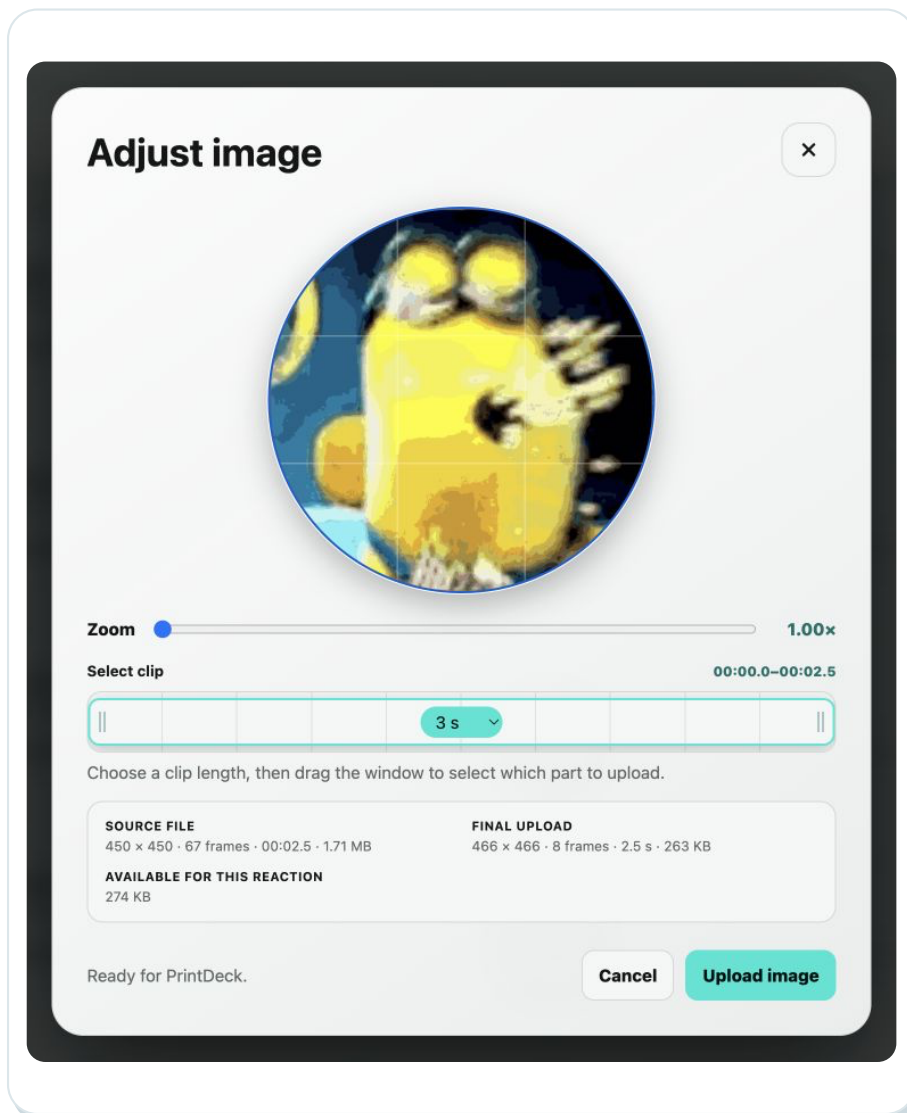
Captured from a physical round PrintDeck



Set downloads are validated before activation. Custom image overrides stay active across set changes and are removed only with Reset to set default.

Custom reaction images

Choose Upload / Replace image on a reaction card, or drag a file directly onto that card. PrintDeck opens this review window before anything is sent to the device.



POSITION & ZOOM

Frame the image

Drag the preview to choose the visible area. Use the Zoom slider or mouse wheel to fill the display without unwanted bars. Static images stop here: they do not show animation controls.

ANIMATED FILES

Choose the useful moment

Select a clip length from 1 to 5 seconds. Drag the outlined window left or right to choose the source range; the preview loops that exact selection. Short files use their available duration.

01 / OPEN

Choose or drop

Use GIF, PNG, JPEG, WebP, AVIF or BMP. HEIC and HEIF work when the browser can decode them.

02 / REVIEW

Check the result

Source and final dimensions, frame count, duration and estimated upload size are shown before upload.

03 / UPLOAD

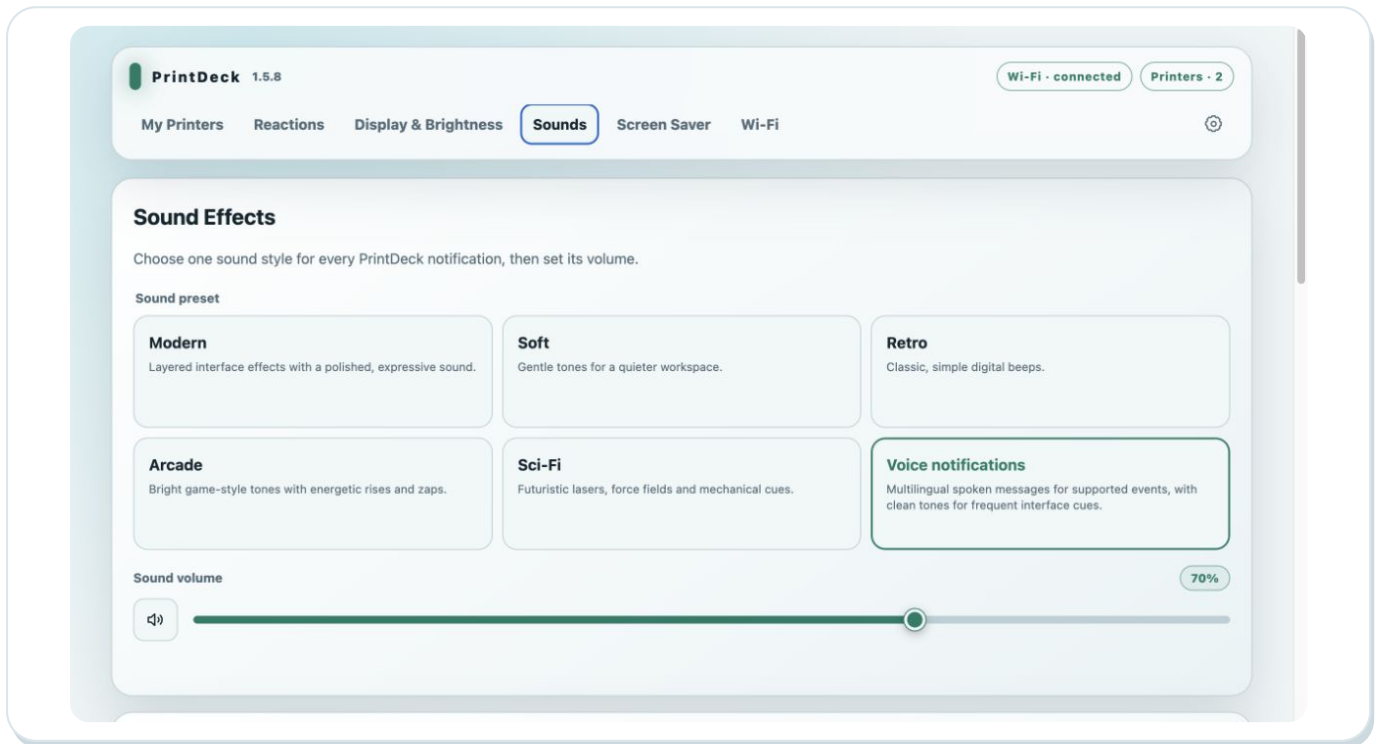
Confirm the change

Choose Upload image, then wait for the spinner to finish. The card is marked Custom after a successful save.

Cancel or close leaves the current reaction unchanged. Reset to set default removes a saved custom image later.

Web Config - Sounds

Choose how PrintDeck confirms actions and announces important printer events in your workspace.



SOUND PRESET

Six distinct sound sets

Choose Modern, Soft, Retro, Arcade, Sci-Fi or Voice Notifications. Voice Notifications speaks supported events in the selected language and uses clean tones for frequent interface cues.

VOLUME & MUTE

Match the room

Set the master volume or mute sound completely. Individual notification events can also be muted without disabling all feedback.

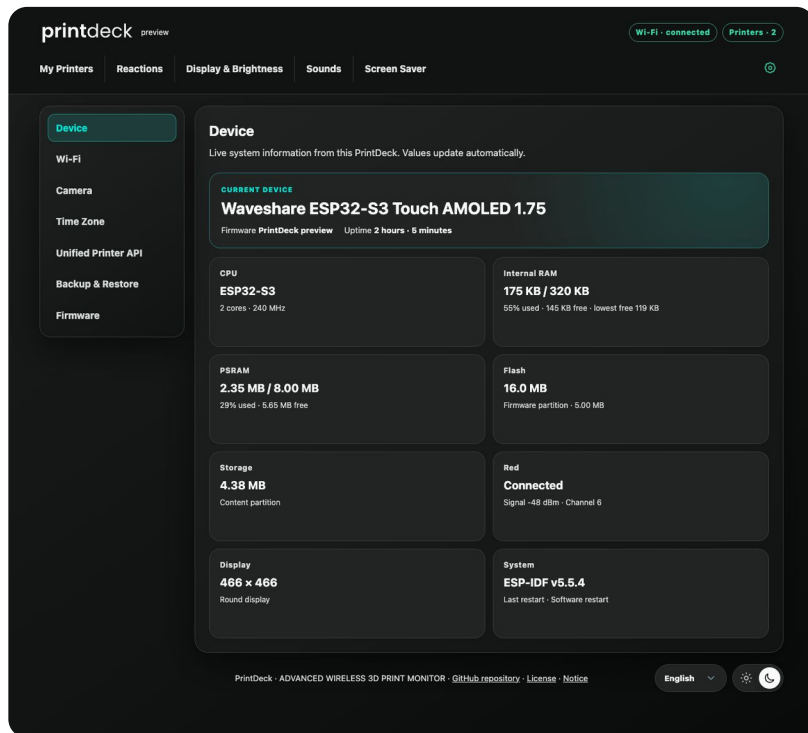
TEST SOUND

Preview before you finish

Use Test sound beside an event to hear the selected preset and volume. Testing plays a preview only and does not change saved event settings.

Web Config - Device & System Settings

Review the current PrintDeck hardware state, then use the remaining tabs to manage idle behaviour, local connectivity, camera preferences, time zone and firmware.



DEVICE

Current state, never history

See the hardware model, firmware, uptime, CPU, current RAM and PSRAM use, Flash capacity, network signal, display and system version. Values refresh only while Device is open and are not stored.

SCREEN & NETWORK

Idle safely and stay local

Open the settings gear, then Wi-Fi directly below Device, or click the Wi-Fi badge in the header. Connect PrintDeck to the same local network as your printers. Screen Saver starts with two off timers. Expand Advanced settings for dimming, USB and wake options; recovery remains available if Wi-Fi cannot be reached.

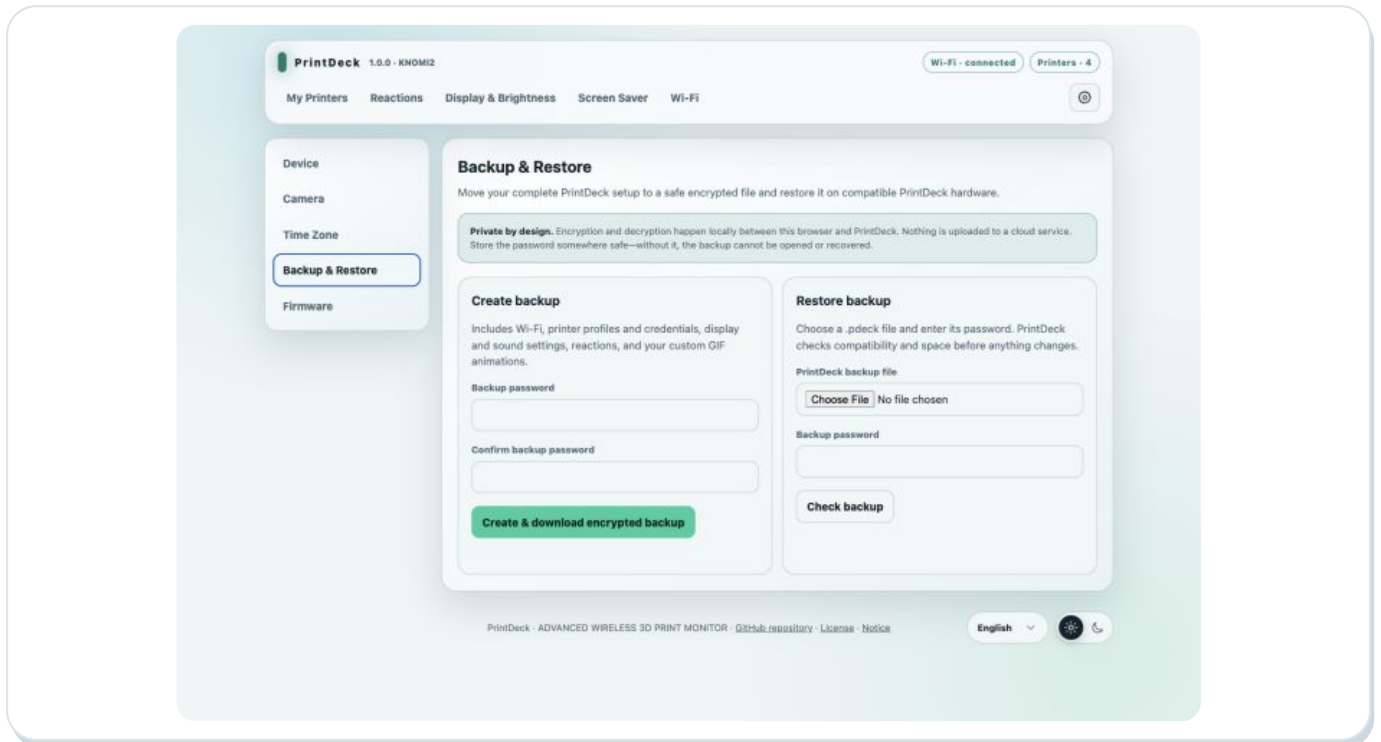
CAMERA, TIME & UPDATES

Tune the remaining device settings

Choose the camera refresh mode, set the time zone used by clocks and install validated PrintDeck firmware. Keep the device powered while an update is validated and restarted.

Web Config - Backup & Restore

Save the complete PrintDeck setup before an update, reset or device replacement, then restore it on the same compatible PrintDeck hardware.



PASSWORDS CANNOT BE RECOVERED

Keep the .pdeck file and its password somewhere safe. Without that exact password, neither PrintDeck nor support can open or restore the backup.

CREATE A BACKUP

One encrypted .pdeck file

Open Device Settings, then Backup & Restore. Enter a password of at least 3 characters twice and choose Create & download encrypted backup. The filename includes the device name or ID and a timestamp. The backup saves the device name, Wi-Fi and printer credentials, profiles, display and sound settings, reactions and custom GIFs. Save the password separately from the file.

RESTORE SAFELY

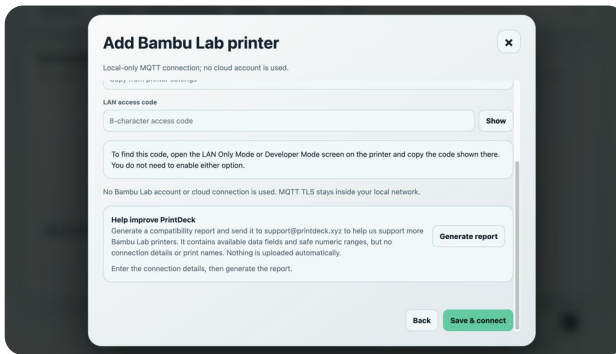
Check first, change second

Choose the .pdeck file, enter its password and select Check backup. Review the hardware, printer count, custom-animation count and file size before restoring. Keep current Wi-Fi settings selected when using your normal network so the page can reconnect after restart. PrintDeck restores custom GIFs one at a time, validates the same per-file and total storage limits, saves configuration last and then restarts.

Credentials, settings and custom GIF content are protected by AES-256-GCM. The key is derived locally from the password; only compatibility and size metadata remain readable. Nothing is uploaded.

Whether you are checking a new printer, choosing compatible third-party components or building your own PrintDeck display, support starts with a direct conversation.

HELP IMPROVE PRINTDECK



DOWNLOAD THE REPORT

Generate locally, then share it yourself

In Web Config open My Printers, choose Add printer, select Bambu Lab and fill in the local connection details. Choose Generate report, review the result and download it. PrintDeck never uploads or sends it automatically. Email the downloaded file to us only when you decide to share it.

LAN-ONLY PRIVACY

Printer credentials and compatibility data remain on PrintDeck and your local network. The report excludes access codes and other connection secrets; you control if and when it leaves your LAN.

COMPONENT GUIDANCE

Planning your own build?

Ask for help choosing a compatible third-party display, cables and optional parts for your own PrintDeck build. PrintDeck is firmware and does not offer a branded ready-to-use device.

INDIVIDUAL ASSEMBLY HELP

Need help putting it together?

Ask about individual help assembling and configuring components for your personal build. Parts remain third-party products and are documented separately from the assembly service; no boxed PrintDeck hardware set is offered.

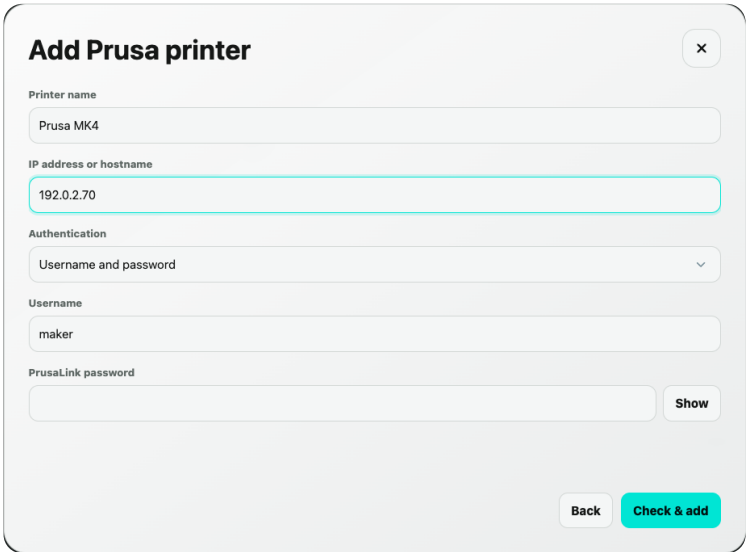
QUESTIONS & COLLABORATION

Tell us what you want to build

For compatibility reports, component guidance, individual assembly help, general questions or collaboration, write to support@printdeck.xyz. Include your printer model and the kind of help you need so we can respond with the right next step.

support@printdeck.xyz

Connect a Prusa



Add Prusa printer ×

Printer name
Prusa MK4

IP address or hostname
192.0.2.70

Authentication
Username and password ▾

Username
maker

PrusaLink password
 Show

Back Check & add

1. Choose Prusa

Open Add printer and choose Prusa, marked Experimental. Discovery can find supported local services; manual entry is always available. Enter a name and the local PrusaLink address.

2. Use your PrusaLink credentials

Choose Username and password, or API key if your PrusaLink provides one. Copy the details from your printer's PrusaLink settings. The username can be changed; maker is only the default. No cloud account is needed.

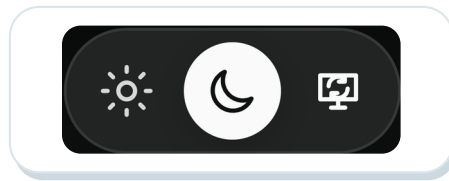
3. Check and add

PrintDeck checks identity, credentials and live status before saving. This check only reads data and cannot start or stop a print. If discovery finds nothing, enter the address manually, including a custom port when needed.

4. Monitor and edit

Select the online printer to see its status, progress, temperatures and available job image. Missing values show placeholders. An unchanged saved connection can retain a blank password or key field; after changing its address, username or authentication method, enter the credentials again.

Page appearance



1. Follow your system

Web Config follows your phone or computer's light or dark appearance by default. The highlighted sun or moon shows the appearance currently in use.

2. Choose light or dark

Select the sun for light appearance or the moon for dark appearance. Your browser remembers the choice; selecting the same icon again keeps that appearance.

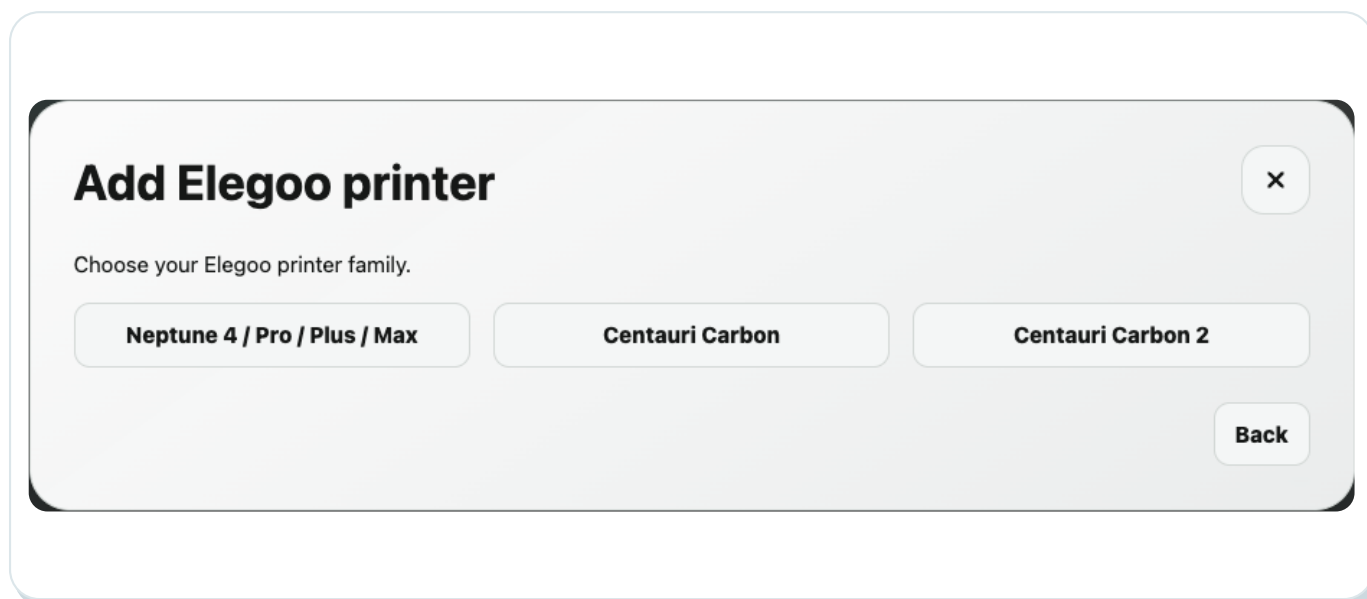
3. Return to automatic

After a manual choice, a monitor with arrows appears beside the sun and moon. Select it to follow your system again. The monitor icon then disappears, and later system changes update the page automatically.

4. Browser appearance only

These controls are available in the footer and during first-time Wi-Fi setup. The choice is shared between tabs for the same Web Config address. It does not change the physical PrintDeck display theme.

Connect an Elegoo



Add Elegoo printer

Choose your Elegoo printer family.

Neptune 4 / Pro / Plus / Max Centauri Carbon Centauri Carbon 2

Back

1. Choose the printer family

Open Add printer, choose Elegoo (Experimental), then choose Neptune 4 / Pro / Plus / Max, Centauri Carbon, or Centauri Carbon 2. These families use different local connections. Other Elegoo models and resin printers are not covered by this option.

2. Enter the local details

Neptune 4 uses the Moonraker form. For Carbon or Carbon 2, enter a name and local address; the identifier can be read automatically. Carbon 2 also needs LAN mode and the access code shown by the printer. No cloud account or extra computer is required.

3. Check and add

PrintDeck verifies identity and current status before saving. Discovery is started only on request; manual entry remains available. If local identity discovery is blocked, check network isolation. No print, movement, heating or filament commands are sent.

4. Monitoring and availability

Choose the online printer to see status, progress, temperatures and available timing. Missing data stays unknown. Carbon camera, thumbnails and CANVAS pages are not yet enabled. Experimental is not a claim that every firmware version has been tested.

Camera and full-screen view



1. Open the camera

Select an online printer and swipe to its camera page. PrintDeck connects directly over your local network while the camera page is visible.

2. Choose live video

For a Snapmaker U1 with the PAXX camera service, PrintDeck detects the local stream automatically. Select Live for continuous video, or Snapshots for periodic still images. Frame rate depends on the printer, Wi-Fi and display hardware. Other camera services keep their supported viewing mode.

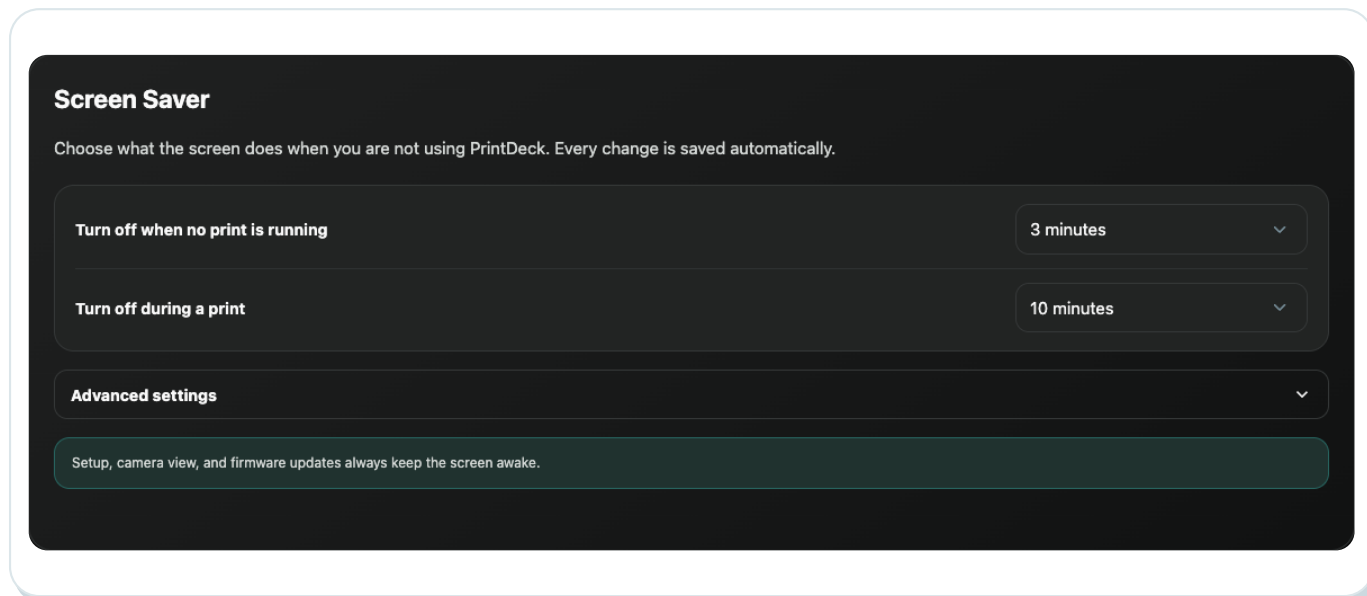
3. Tap to fill the screen

Tap the camera image to fill the entire display and hide the headings, controls and navigation dots. The picture keeps its proportions; its sides are cropped to fit. Tap again to return to the normal view. Drag from inside the enlarged image to move the cropped view. Movement is limited to the image edges.

4. Leave the view

In full-screen view, start a swipe at the display edge to change pages. A stationary long press opens Quick Menu. Leaving the camera page or turning the display fully off stops camera reception. Returning to the page starts a fresh view.

Screen Saver



1. Choose two timers

Set when the screen turns off with no print running and during a print. Each change saves automatically.

2. Confirm Never

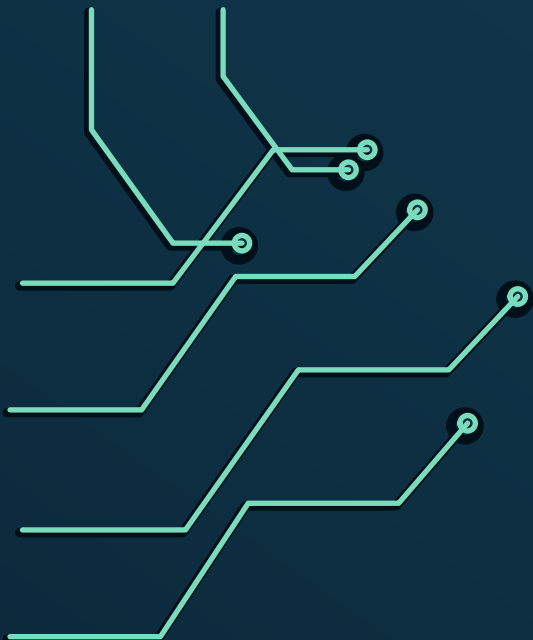
Never disables automatic screen off only for the chosen print state. Confirm Keep screen on to save it, or Cancel to keep the previous time. AMOLED devices also warn about permanent burn-in from prolonged static images.

3. Open Advanced settings

Expand Advanced settings for dimming, dimmed brightness, separate dim timers, USB power and orientation wake. Collapsing this section preserves all values. Dimming and USB rules still apply when Never is selected.

4. Wake for printer events

With reactions enabled, a changed activity of the active printer wakes the screen and restarts the timer. Initial, unavailable and standby reports stay quiet. Print start, completion and 100 percent progress also wake the screen without reactions.



PrintDeck

PRINT SMARTER. STAY PRESENT.

A local-first printer companion for the displays you can keep exactly where you need them.



START HERE

Manual, installer and case designs

Scan to open the PrintDeck website, then choose the path that matches your device and build.

<https://printdeck.xyz/>
support@printdeck.xyz



AMOLED + LCD

LOCAL BY DESIGN

Resin printer status



1. Open the resin screen

Select an online GK3 Ultra in My Printers. If Reactions is enabled, swipe vertically from Reactions to Status; otherwise Status opens directly. Swipe horizontally back to My Printers.

2. Read the current job

Status shows the job thumbnail, filename, remaining and elapsed time, layers and progress. Missing values use a dash; a missing thumbnail uses the manufacturer logo. A new job clears the old image and filename.

3. Follow the layer cycle

The stage follows homing, lowering, exposure, lifting, pause and completion. During exposure, an available CTB layer image replaces the model and stays for two extra seconds afterward. Pausing restores the model immediately; slow downloads leave it visible. The image is a slice from the print file, not a UV measurement. Pause/Resume and Stop are on the next horizontal levels.

4. Full-screen preview

Tap the thumbnail to zoom, drag inside to pan and tap again to return. Model/layer changes update the open zoom. A new job closes it. Hold still for Quick Menu; swipe from an edge to navigate. FDM previews work the same way.

Home Assistant with MQTT

MQTT

Send printer data to your local MQTT broker, such as Mosquitto.

Connected

Enable MQTT to make this PrintDeck available to the PrintDeck integration in Home Assistant. HTTP access remains independent.

MQTT topic root

printdeck/preview-amoled/v1

Broker address

mosquitto.local

Broker port

1883

Broker username

printdeck

Broker password

Show password

If your broker requires a password, enter it here.

Connection security

Local connection without TLS

Save broker settings

1. Prepare Mosquitto

Install the Mosquitto broker app in Home Assistant, or use your existing local broker. Configure the MQTT integration in Home Assistant and create broker credentials for PrintDeck. Both must connect to the same broker.

2. Connect PrintDeck

Open Web Config > Device Settings > Unified API. MQTT ON/OFF saves immediately after the broker is configured; OFF asks for confirmation. For first setup, select ON, enter the broker address, port and credentials, then Save & connect. Use an address reachable from PrintDeck. Save broker settings applies later field edits. OFF hides the fields but keeps saved credentials. REST API has its own switch and hides its token and endpoints when off.

Home Assistant with MQTT

3. Choose one Home Assistant path

Discovery is a separate section and requires MQTT. Turn it ON for Home Assistant's built-in MQTT integration. Keep it OFF for the PrintDeck HACS integration. Its switch saves immediately; OFF warns that automatically created entities will be removed. Keep MQTT connected during cleanup. HACS proposes devices only when MQTT is on and standard Discovery is off; REST API alone does not trigger a proposal. Discovered devices supply the topic automatically. Only manual setup needs the topic root.

4. Use the same automations

Select state and progress entities in the print-finished and progress-milestone blueprints. Reconfigure an existing PrintDeck HACS entry to switch HTTP and MQTT while preserving entity identities. When moving between generic MQTT Discovery and HACS, select the new entities in dashboards and automations.

5. Factory reset and MQTT

Before a factory reset, disable Discovery and wait for cleanup. If the broker is unreachable, the reset dialog offers an unchecked option to proceed without cleanup. Select it only if you will manually remove PrintDeck's retained Discovery configuration from the old broker and its MQTT entities from Home Assistant afterwards.